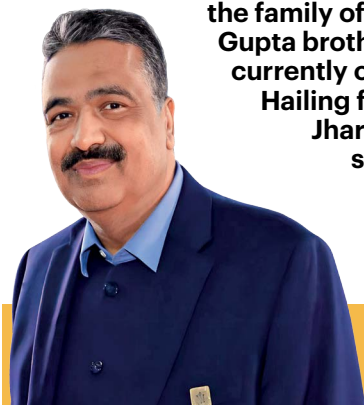


JKC'S MYSTERY MEN

MURARI LAL JALAN OWNER, MJ DEVELOPERS

▶ The owner of Dubai-based MJ Developers, Jalan remains an enigma, with many in India Inc. only hearing of him after JKC's resolution plan for Jet Airways' revival was approved. He is said to have business interests in sectors such as paper trading, real estate, dairy, consumer durables, and mining, among others. Other than the Middle East, MJ Developers operates in the Commonwealth of Independent States (CIS), Brazil and India. Jalan's niece is married into the family of South Africa's Gupta brothers, who are currently on the run. Hailing from Ranchi in Jharkhand, Jalan is said to keep a low profile.

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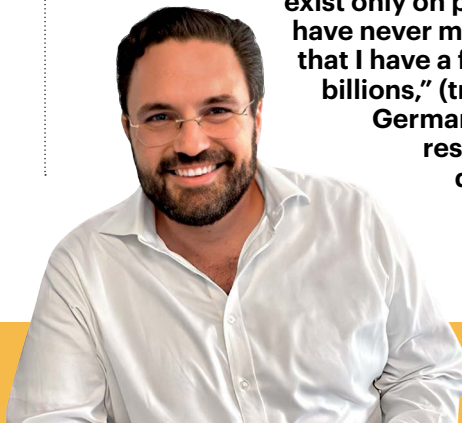


Many continue to have fond memories of the service benchmarks that Jet Airways established in the industry and earnestly hope that it makes a comeback. Salil Gupte, President of Boeing India, who started his career as an investment banker in New York, is one of them. "Jet was one of our largest customers prior to its grounding. And it's an iconic brand. The Jet Privilege [loyalty] programme was one of the most prominent in the region. And there's clearly a number of assets and a significant amount of goodwill that still exists in the Indian market for it," he says.

Securing an AOC will be JKC's next step

FLORIAN FRITSCH PROMOTER, KALROCK CAPITAL PARTNERS

▶ Fritsch's website describes him as a prominent investor, consultant and business angel who started his first company at the age of 16. As promoter of Kalrock Capital, he is credited with having made successful investments in diverse businesses such as real estate, electric mobility and renewable energy. A November 2022 investigation by the German business daily *Handelsblatt* insinuated that Fritsch's fortune may exist only on paper. "I myself have never made the claim that I have a fortune worth billions," (translated from German) he said in response to a query from the newspaper.



towards revival. "The silver lining is that they have done this once earlier," says Reeva Chugh Arora, Founding Partner at New Delhi-based law firm AviLeague Partners. After the re-certification, the airline will have to survive in a hypercompetitive environment. "A lot has changed in the past four-plus years since Jet Airways was grounded. Now, the market has the well-established low-cost carrier IndiGo, full-service carriers Air India and Vistara backed by the Tata group, and Akasa Air as its competitors. Popular routes such as Delhi-Mumbai will be hard to grab."

KNOWN UNKNOWNNS

A view in the aviation industry is that the revival of Jet Airways has faced headwinds due to the lack of pedigree among consortium owners Murari Lal Jalan and Florian Fritsch in the aviation industry. Former Jet Airways staff *BT* spoke to for